

**RWANDA**

Capital city: Kigali
Area: 10,169 sq miles (26,338 sq km)
Population: 8,400,000
Official languages: French and Kinyarwanda
Major religions: Traditional beliefs 50%, Christian 45%, other 5%
Government: Multi-party democracy
Currency: Rwanda franc
Adult literacy rate: 69%
Life expectancy: 40 years
People per doctor: 20,000
Televisions: No figures available

BURUNDI

Capital city: Bujumbura
Area: 10,745 sq miles (27,830 sq km)
Population: 6,800,000
Official languages: French and Kirundi
Major religions: Christian 60%, traditional beliefs 39%, Muslim 1%
Government: Transitional government
Currency: Burundi franc
Adult literacy rate: 50%
Life expectancy: 42 years
People per doctor: 10,000
Televisions: 4 per 1,000 people

RWANDA

SINCE 1994, RWANDA HAS rarely been out of the news. War between the two main ethnic groups – the Tutsi and Hutu – has torn Rwanda apart and wrecked its economy, leaving it one of the poorest countries in the world. Before the war, Rwanda's main export was coffee. Today, although 95 percent of the people still live off the land, few crops are grown for export. The country's instability has also hindered attempts to develop manufacturing and mining industries.



There are only about 650 gorillas left in the world. The mountain gorilla is found only in this region of Africa.

**HEALTH**

Rwanda is one of Africa's most densely populated countries and the population continues to grow. Most Rwandan women have at least six children, compared to an average of only one or two in developed countries. However, few Rwandans live to be over 50. Diseases such as malaria and AIDS are common, and medical facilities are in short supply and are rarely free, so few people can afford them.

BURUNDI

UNTIL INDEPENDENCE IN 1962, Burundi and neighboring Rwanda formed one country. Like Rwanda, Burundi is home to both Tutsi and Hutu people, and the wars between these tribes have been part of Burundi's history, too. In 1972, about 10,000 Hutu were killed by Tutsis. Warfare continues today, although a peace agreement was reached in 2000. Burundi's problems are made worse by fighting in neighboring Democratic Republic of the Congo.

DRUMMING GROUPS

In Burundi, stories, songs, and music are passed down from generation to generation rather than written down in a formal way. Tutsi folk dancing is one of the highlights of traditional culture, as are the groups of 12 to 15 drummers who play together with no other instruments.

**GENOCIDE**

In 1994, centuries-old tensions between the majority Hutu and minority Tutsi populations boiled over into one of the world's worst acts of genocide (the murder of one ethnic group). Around 800,000 of the previously dominant Tutsi were massacred alongside some of their Hutu supporters. Over one million Rwandans fled the country. Although peace has been restored, few people have been put on trial and tensions remain high.

MOUNTAIN GORILLAS

One of the last known refuges for the mountain gorilla is the Volcanoes National Park in Rwanda. Even though the gorilla is protected here, it is still in danger of extinction by poachers, and its habitat is threatened by farming.

**POPULATION PRESSURE**

Most people in Burundi make a living from farming. So many people live in the most fertile areas that land is very scarce. Plots of land are usually just large enough to support a family in good years, but bad weather or disease can lead to widespread famine. In some areas, the land is so overused that the soil has begun to erode.

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